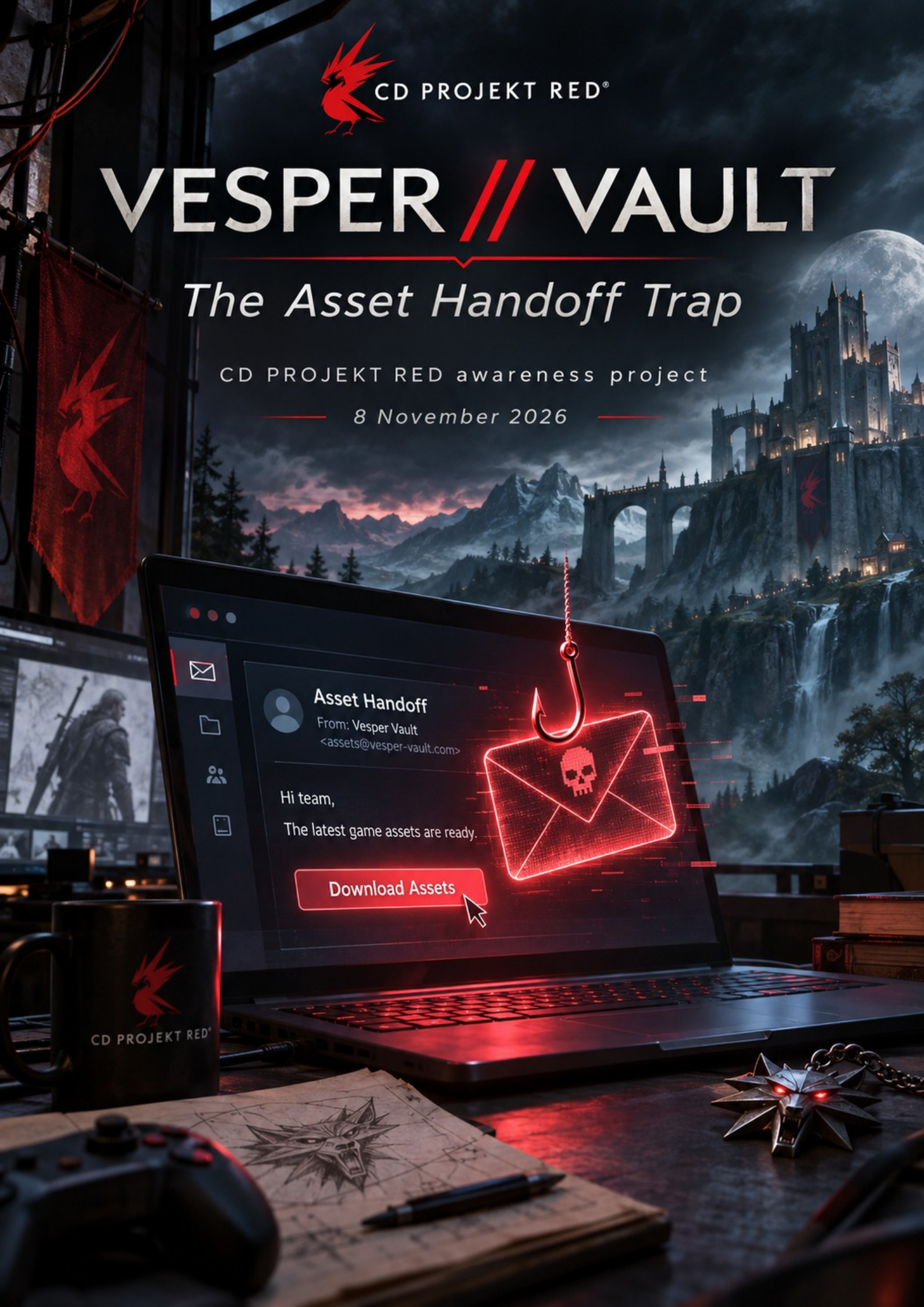

CD PROJEKT RED®
VESPER // VAULT
The Asset Handoff Trap
CD PROJEKT RED awareness project
8 November 2026
Asset Handoff
From: Vesper Vault
<assets@vesper-vault.com>
Hi team,
The latest game assets are ready.
Download Assets
CD PROJEKT RED®

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A look at the project, from installation and email delivery to the results and security lessons.

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01 Project Vesper: the email scenario

CD PROJEKT RED (CDPR) is a Polish game studio known for The Witcher and Cyberpunk 2077. Our project shows how a game developer or artist could receive a suspicious email that looks like a normal request from an outside art studio.

In this scenario, an outside art studio says it has updated character designs for a fictional game called Project Vesper. The email mentions the VESPER-07 package, Revision 03, and an upcoming review. The link opens VESPER // VAULT, a fake site for sharing artwork. Its button reveals a security-awareness message. No passwords are collected.

Target audience

The project focuses on developers, artists, art leads, and producers who work with outside studios. They often receive design files, so this email may seem normal at first. The risk is trusting an unknown sender or opening a link without checking where it leads.

Objective

The project shows how the email is sent, where its link leads, and what Gophish records. It also shows why game developers should check unexpected requests, protect their accounts, and report suspicious messages.

02 How the email travels

Gophish manages the campaign: it stores the email design, landing page, test recipients, and results. MailHog acts as a test email inbox. SMTP (Simple Mail Transfer Protocol) is the set of rules Gophish uses to send the message to MailHog. SMTP is not a separate application.

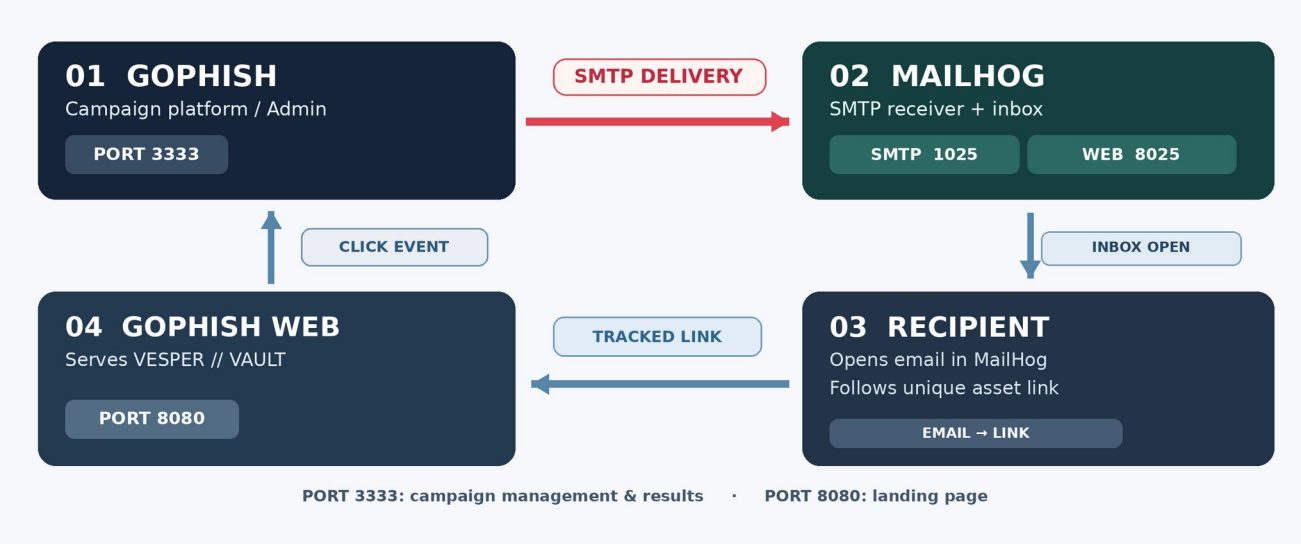


Figure 1. Gophish sends the email to MailHog using SMTP. Clicking the link opens the landing page hosted by Gophish.

Port	Component	Purpose
3333	Gophish Admin	Creates campaigns and shows results
8080	Gophish Web	Opens the VESPER asset-review website
1025	MailHog SMTP	Receives emails from Gophish
8025	MailHog Web	Displays the emails in a browser

Gophish sends the message to MailHog on port 1025. The email then appears in MailHog's web inbox on port 8025. Its link opens the Gophish landing page on port 8080. The Gophish dashboard on port 3333 shows the campaign results.

03 Installing MailHog and Gophish

Docker is already installed on Kali Linux. MailHog runs inside a Docker container named cdpr-mailhog. Gophish runs directly on Kali from the CDPR-gophish folder.

Setting up MailHog

```
sudo systemctl start docker
sudo docker run -d --name cdpr-mailhog \
  -p 127.0.0.1:1025:1025 \
  -p 127.0.0.1:8025:8025 \
  mailhog/mailhog
sudo docker ps
```

The Docker settings connect port 1025 to MailHog's email receiver and port 8025 to its web inbox. The docker ps output shows that the MailHog container is running.

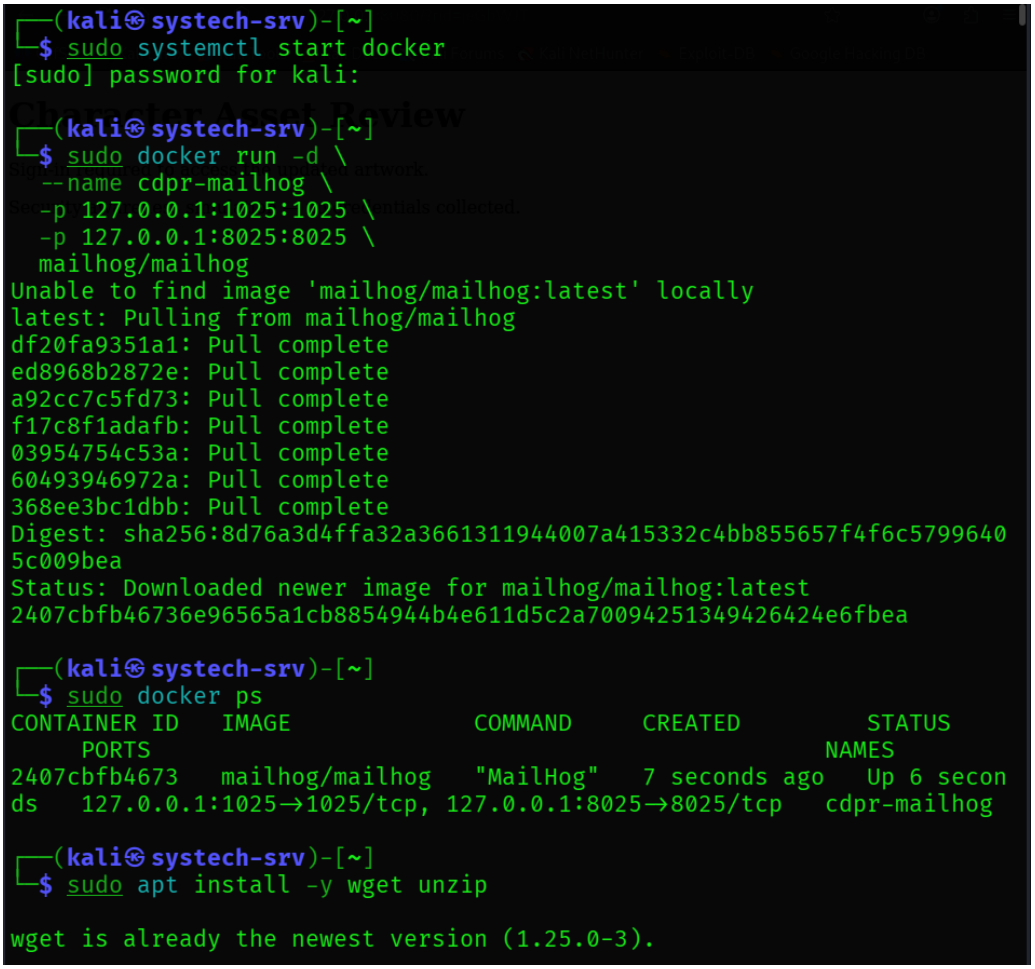


Figure 2. The MailHog Docker container starts in Kali and shows its two ports.

Installing Gophish

```
sudo apt install -y wget unzip
mkdir -p ~/CDPR-gophish
cd ~/CDPR-gophish
wget -O gophish.zip \
  https://github.com/gophish/gophish/releases/download/v0.12.1/gophish-v0.12.1-linux-64bit.zip
unzip gophish.zip
chmod +x gophish
```

Gophish version 0.12.1 is downloaded into the CDPR-gophish folder. The ZIP file is extracted, and the gophish program is made executable.

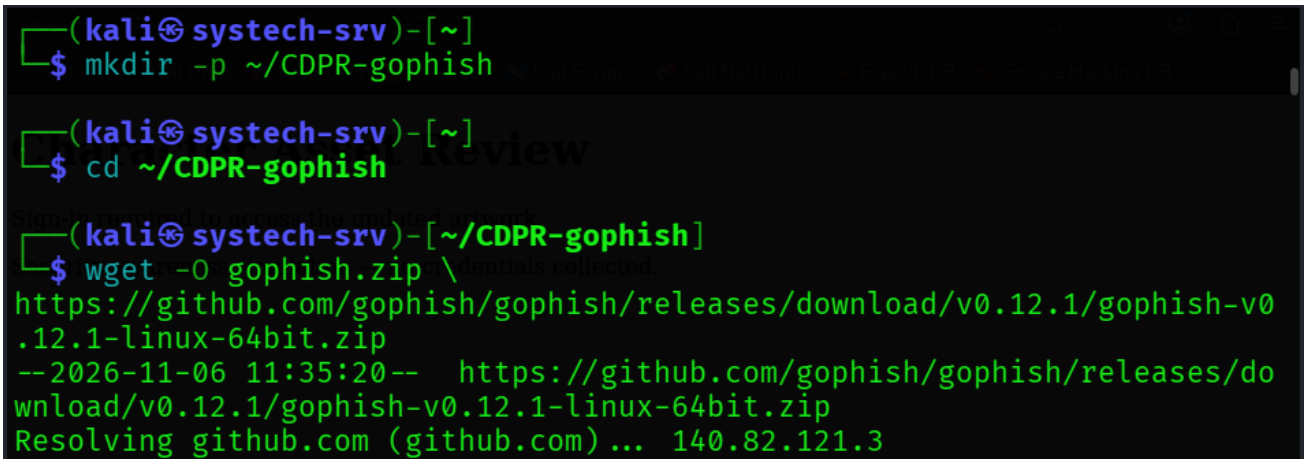


Figure 3. The project folder is created and Gophish is downloaded.

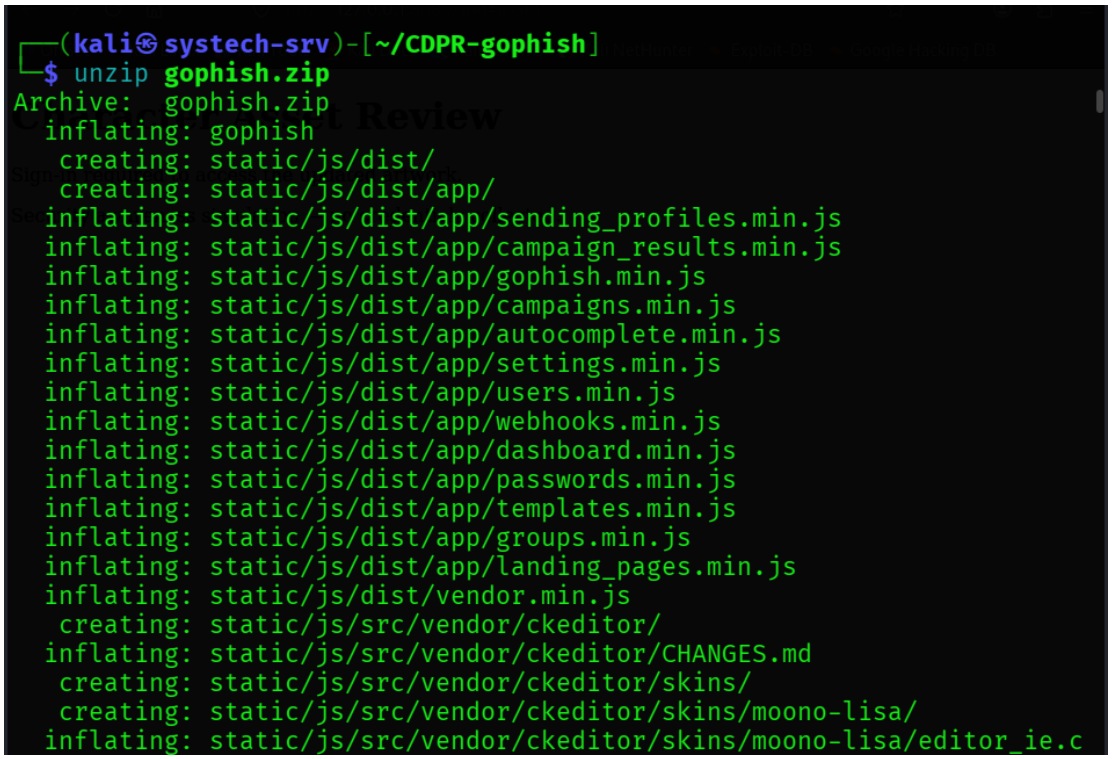


Figure 4. The Gophish files are extracted in Kali.

04 Gophish ports and email settings

The config.json file sets the addresses and ports for the Gophish dashboard and landing page. The email-delivery address is set separately in Gophish under Sending Profiles.

Gophish ports

```
cd ~/CDPR-gophish
nano config.json
```

```
"admin_server": { "listen_url": "127.0.0.1:3333", "use_tls": true },
"phish_server": { "listen_url": "127.0.0.1:8080", "use_tls": false }
```

The dashboard uses port 3333, and the landing page uses port 8080. Whether the dashboard opens with HTTP or HTTPS depends on the TLS setting. The original configuration enables HTTPS, while some browser views show HTTP, so the protocol in use depends on the version currently running.

```
cd ~/CDPR-gophish
./gophish
```

```
┌──(kali㉿systech-srv)-[~/CDPR-gophish]
└─$ chmod +x gophish

┌──(kali㉿systech-srv)-[~/CDPR-gophish]
└─$ nano config.json

┌──(kali㉿systech-srv)-[~/CDPR-gophish]
└─$ ./gophish
time="2026-11-06T11:37:43-05:00" level=warning msg="No contact address
has been configured."
time="2026-11-06T11:37:43-05:00" level=warning msg="Please consider add
ing a contact_address entry in your config.json"
goose: migrating db environment 'production', current version: 0, targe
t: 20220321133237
OK    20160118194630_init.sql
```

Figure 5. Gophish starts from the CDPR-gophish folder.

Connecting Gophish to MailHog

The Sending Profile is named CDPR Local SMTP. It sends as External Artist <artist@example.test> and uses 127.0.0.1:1025 to reach MailHog. The Send Test Email button checks whether MailHog receives a message; it does not test the landing page.

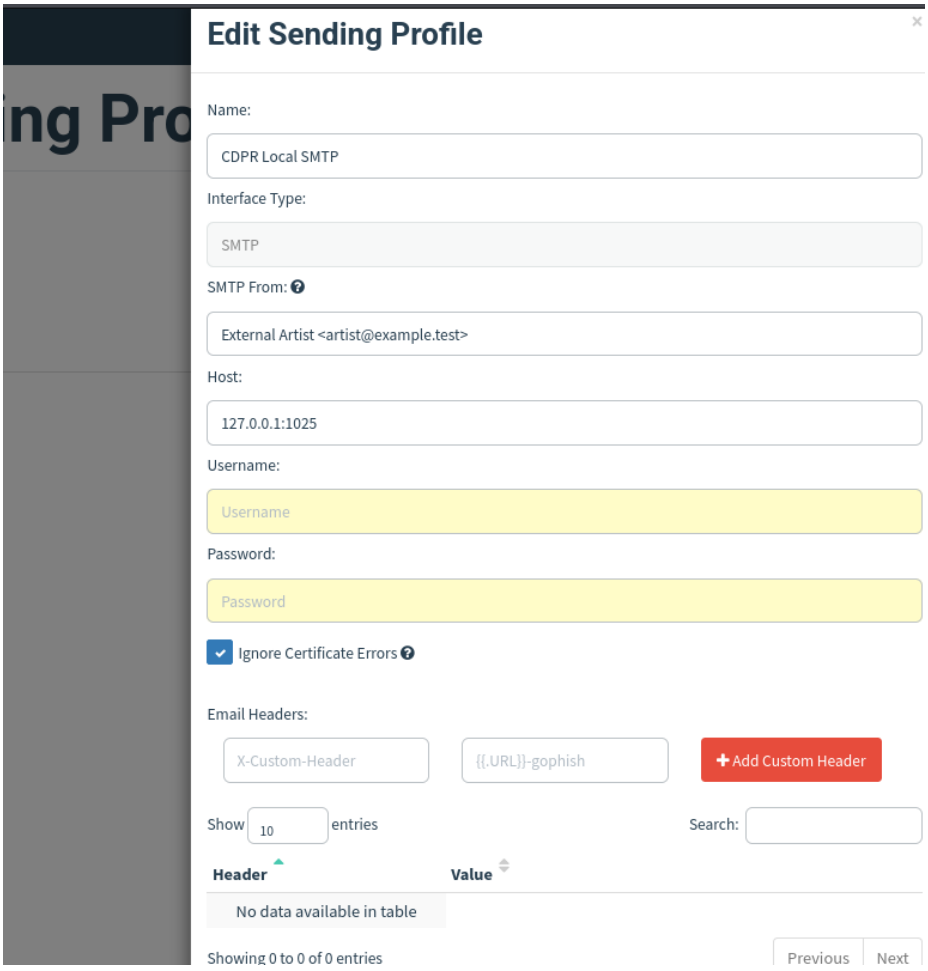


Figure 6. The sending profile uses MailHog's SMTP port, 1025.

05 The email, landing page and test developers

The email template

The VESPER-07 email appears to come from an outside concept-art studio. Its OPEN ASSET REVIEW button is an HTML link. Gophish replaces {{.URL}} with a different tracking link for each recipient. The email button does not use JavaScript.

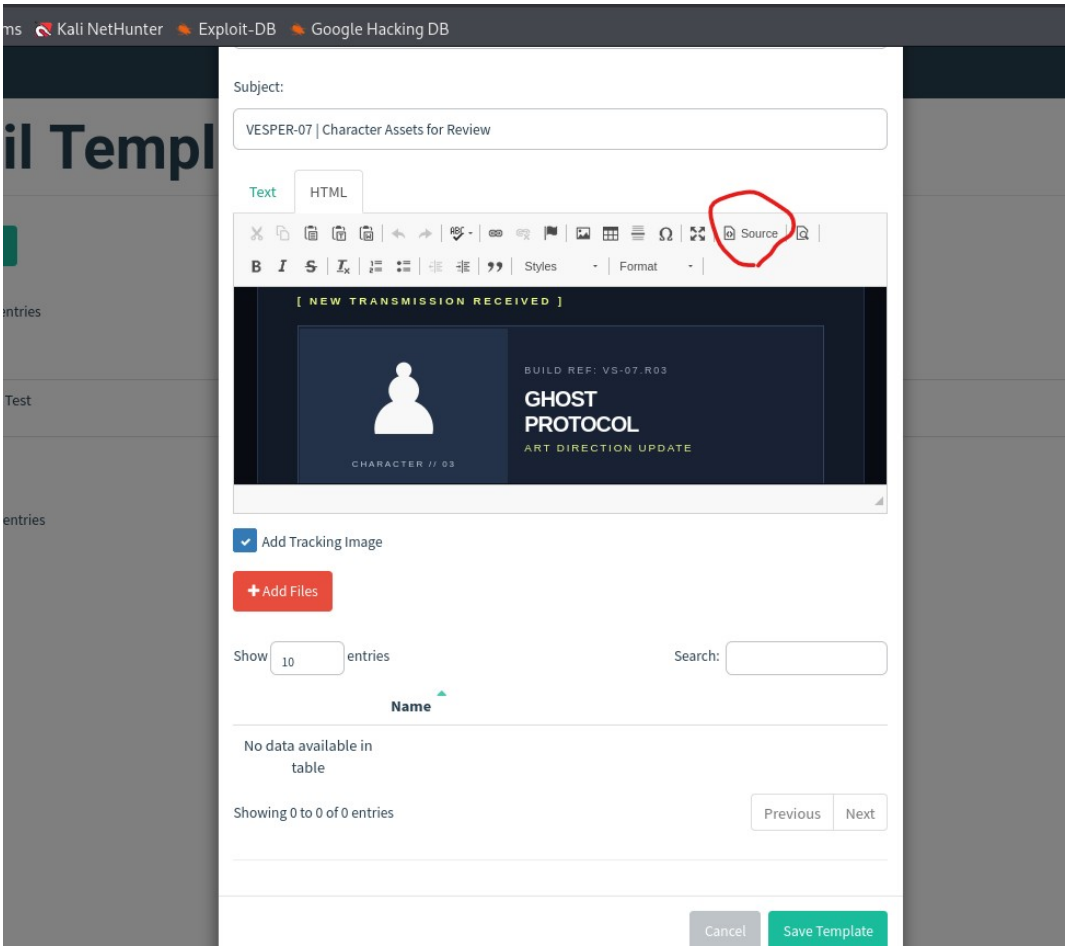


Figure 7. The VESPER-07 email in the Gophish template editor.

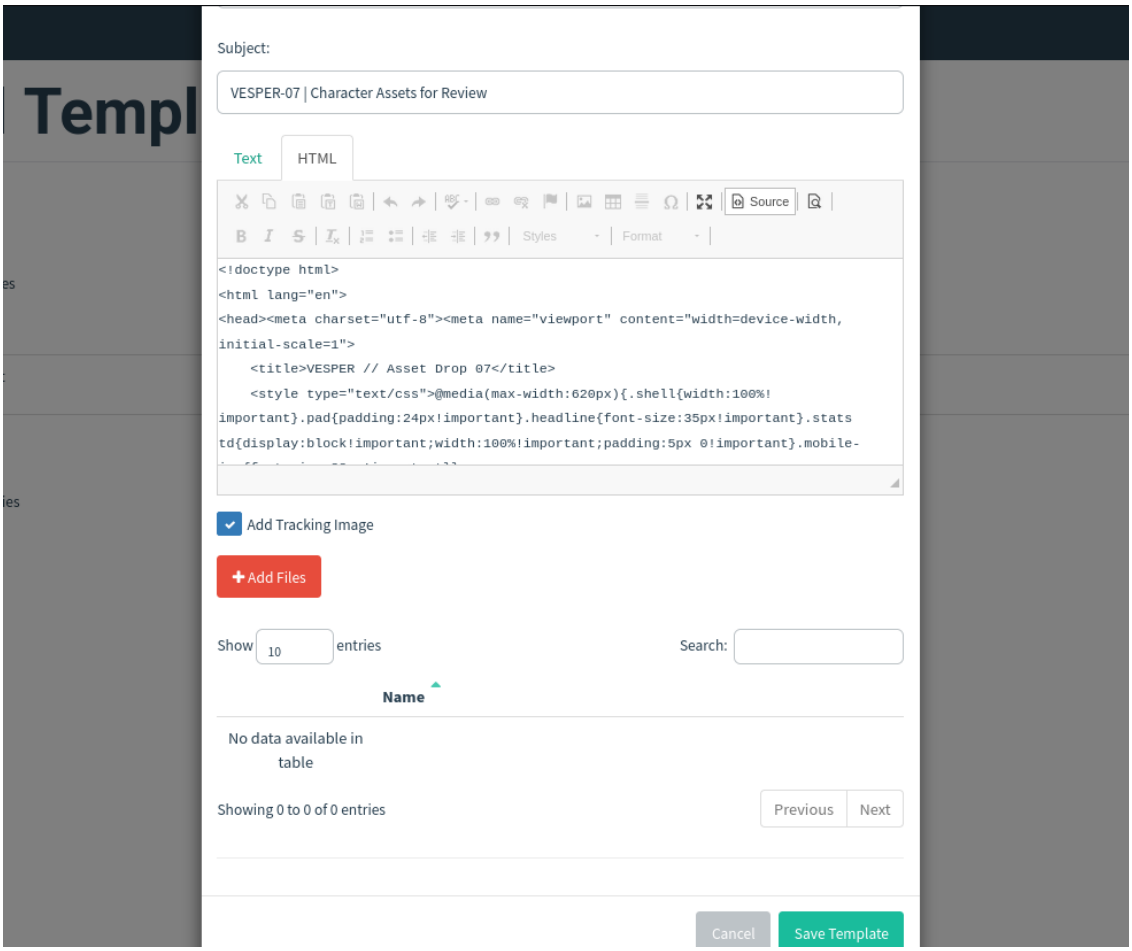


Figure 8. The email's HTML in the Gophish editor.

The landing page

The email link opens VESPER // VAULT, a fake website for viewing character artwork. The REQUEST ASSET ACCESS button shows an awareness message using JavaScript. It does not increase the Clicked Link count: Gophish records that when the link in the email is opened. The landing page has no working password-collection form.

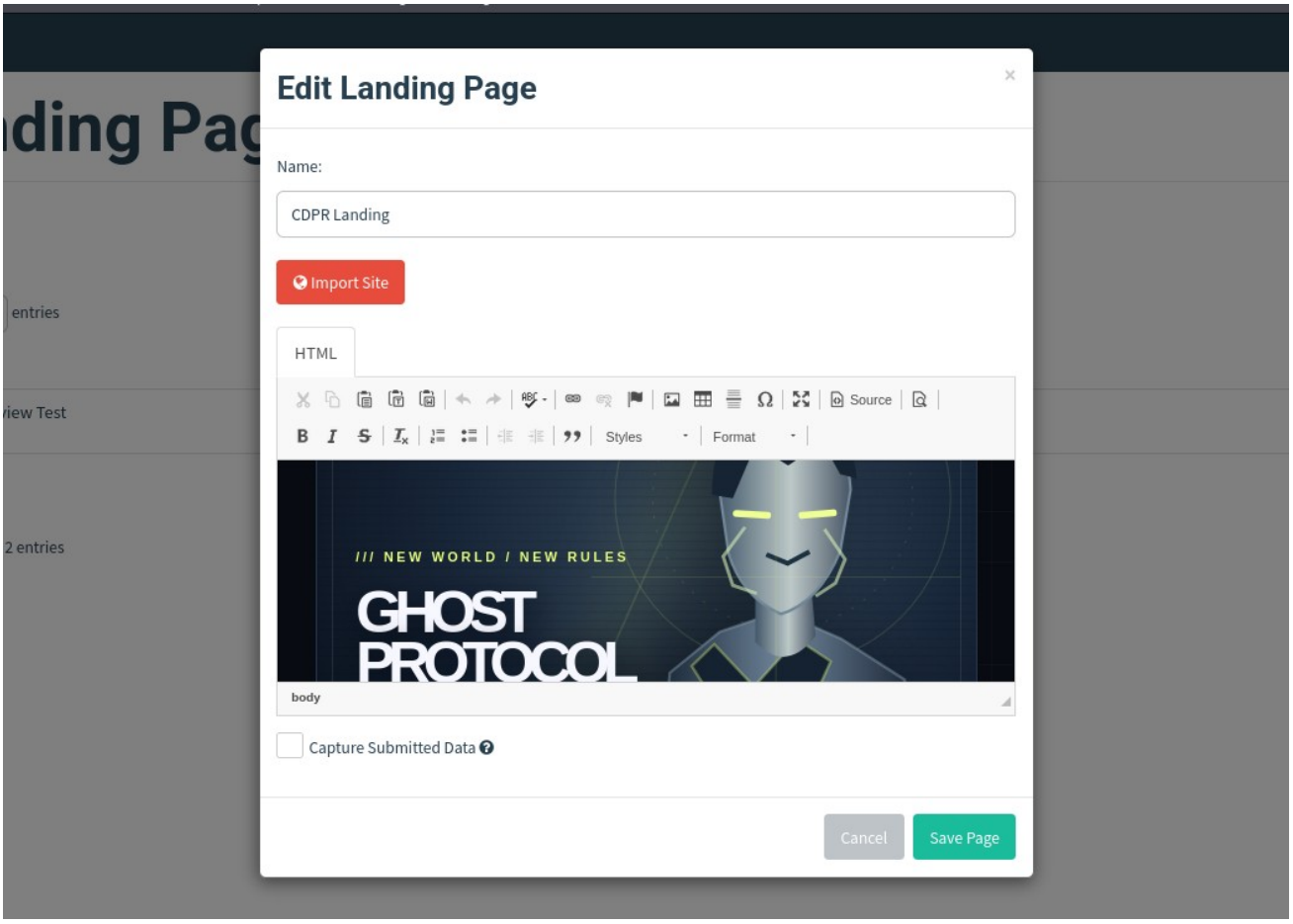


Figure 9. The VESPER // VAULT page in the Gophish landing-page editor.

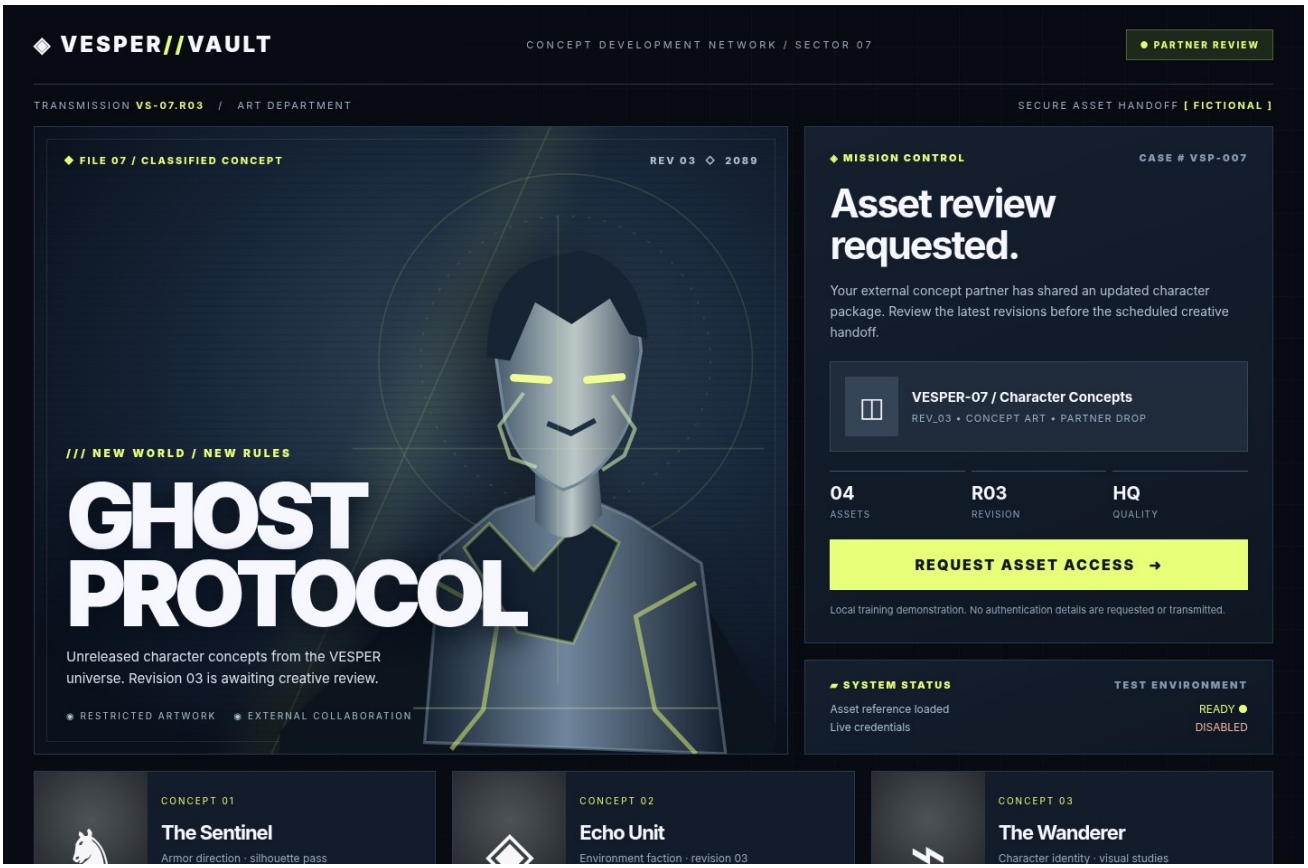


Figure 10. The final VESPER // VAULT landing page.

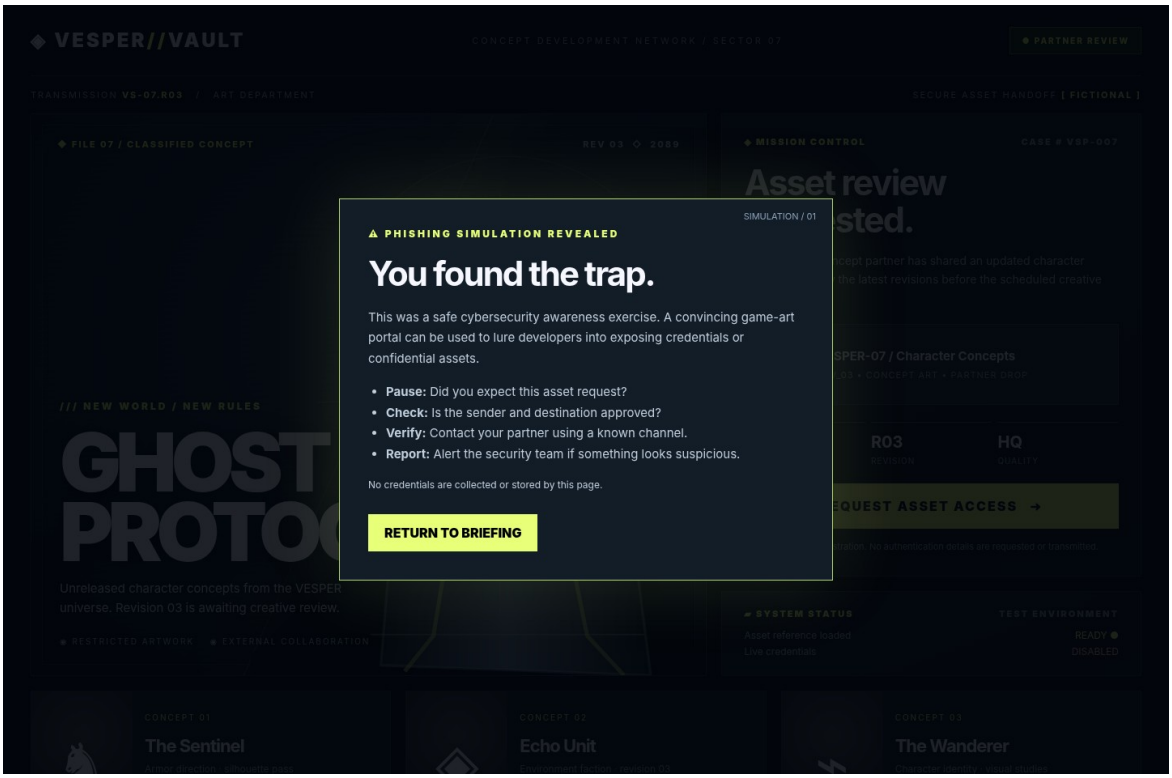


Figure 11. The awareness message appears after REQUEST ASSET ACCESS is clicked.

The test developers

The CDPR Test Developers group includes two made-up employees: developer1@example.test and developer2@example.test. They represent developers receiving the email. Gophish gives each person a different tracking link so the campaign can show who clicked.

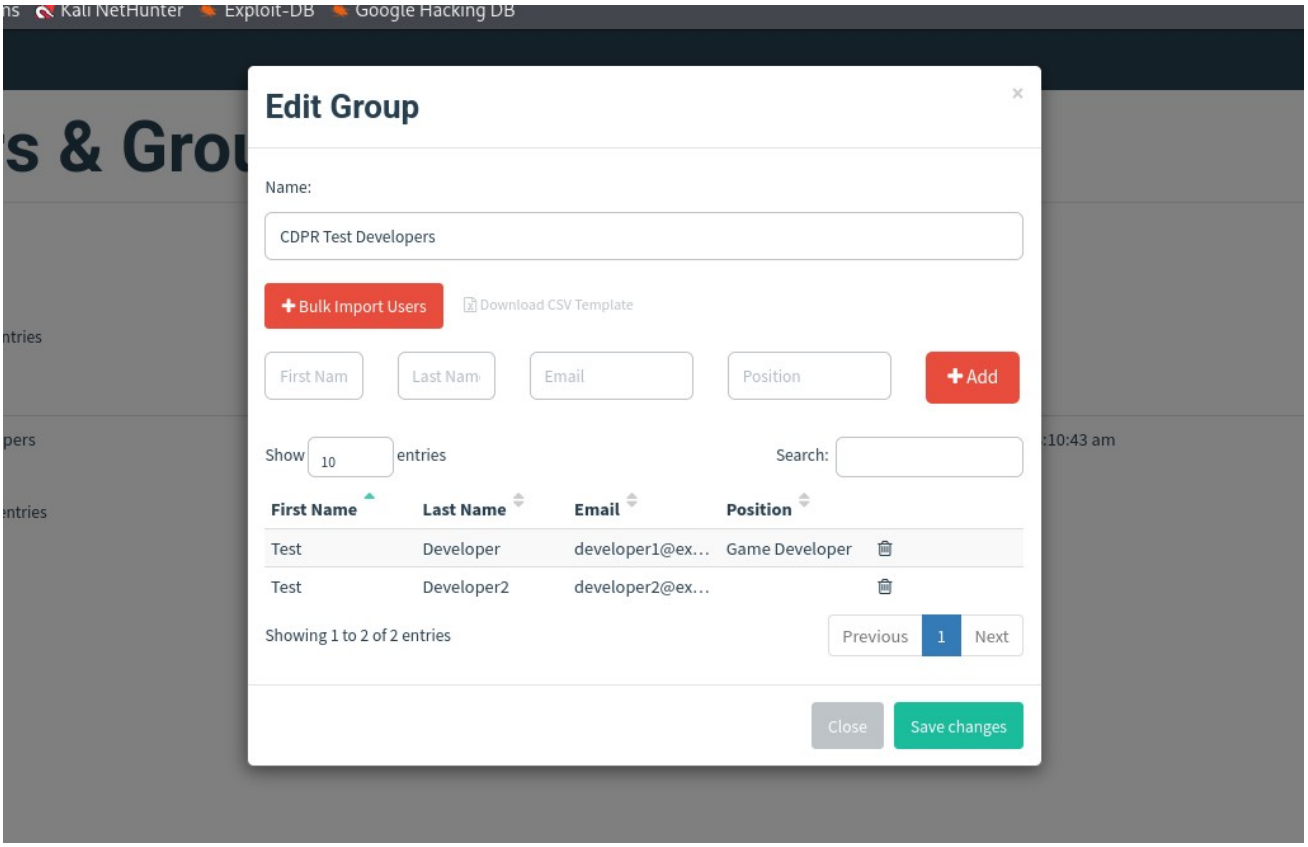


Figure 12. The two test recipients in Gophish Users & Groups.

06 CDPR Demo: campaign and results

Campaign settings

The campaign is called CDPR Demo. It uses the VESPER-07 email, the VESPER // VAULT landing page, the CDPR Local SMTP profile, the CDPR Test Developers group, and http://127.0.0.1:8080 as the landing-page address. Each test developer receives an email with a separate tracking link.

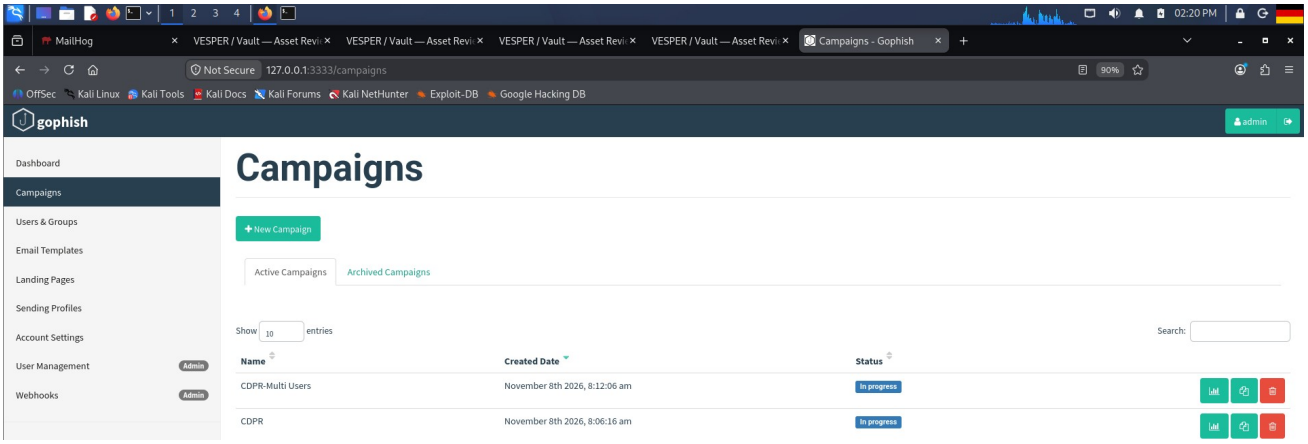


Figure 13. The Gophish campaign list.

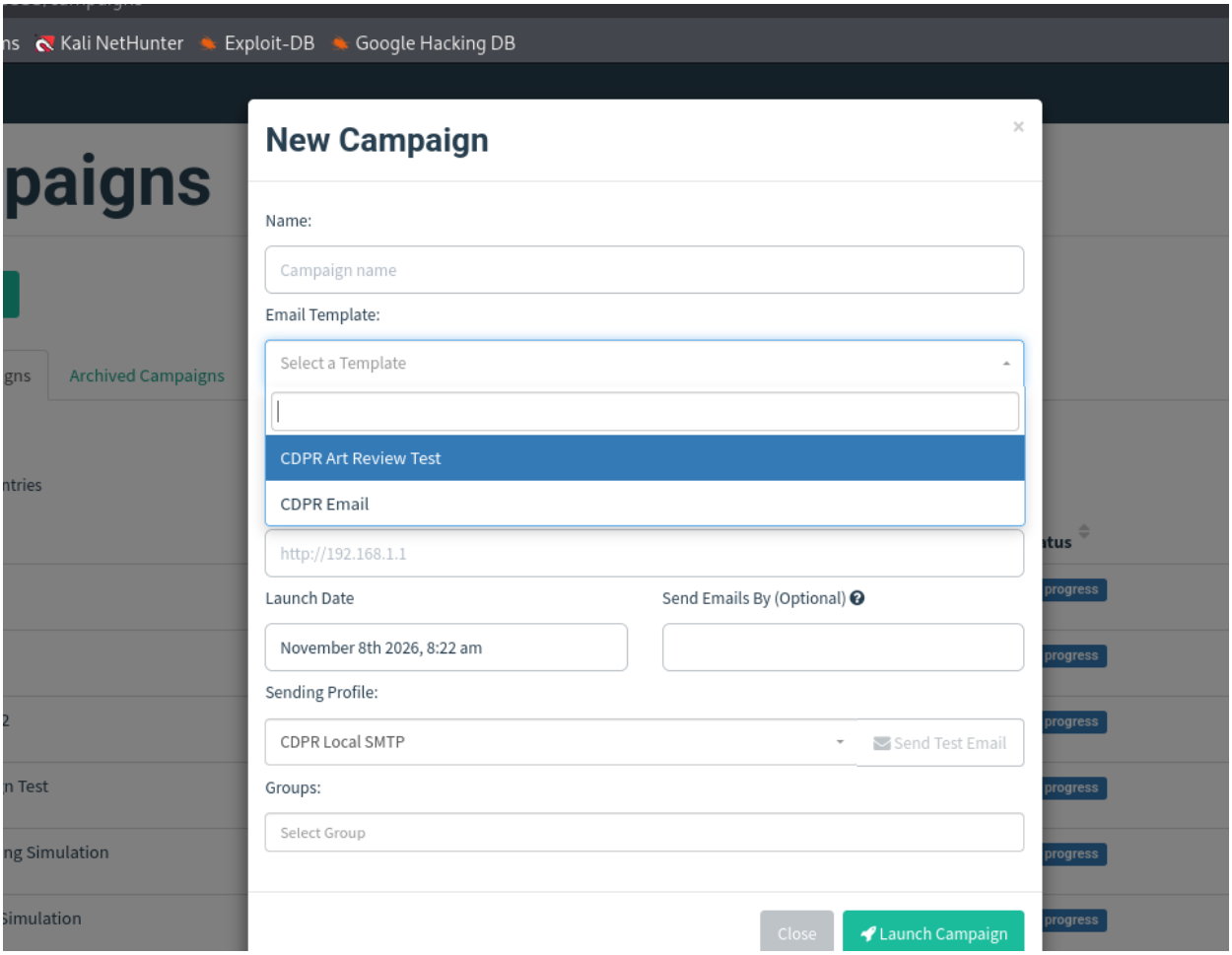


Figure 14. The campaign setup screen with the available email templates.

Email delivery in MailHog

MailHog receives the email and shows the sender, recipient, and subject. In the final email view, the message is addressed to Test Developer2 and includes the OPEN ASSET REVIEW button.

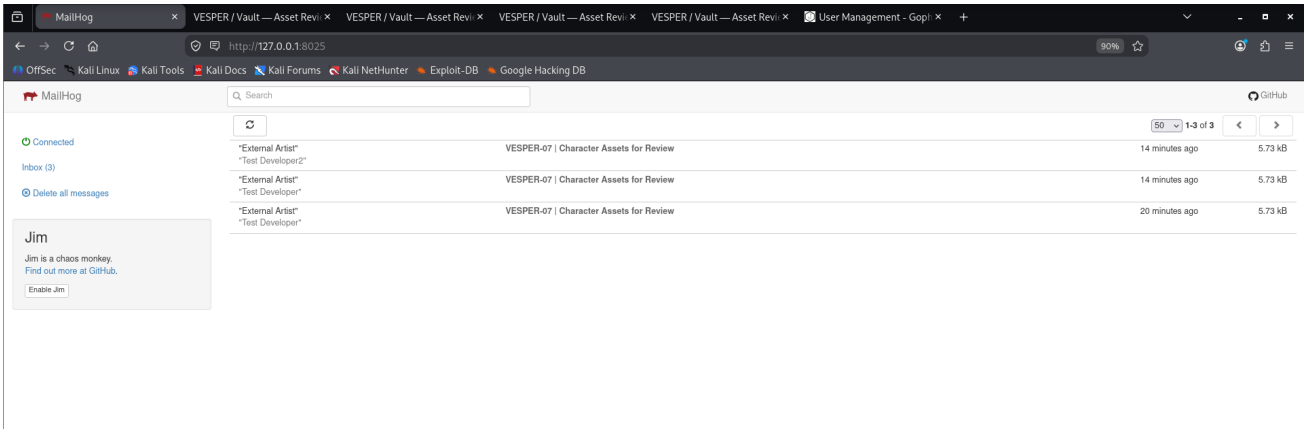


Figure 15. The test emails in the MailHog inbox.

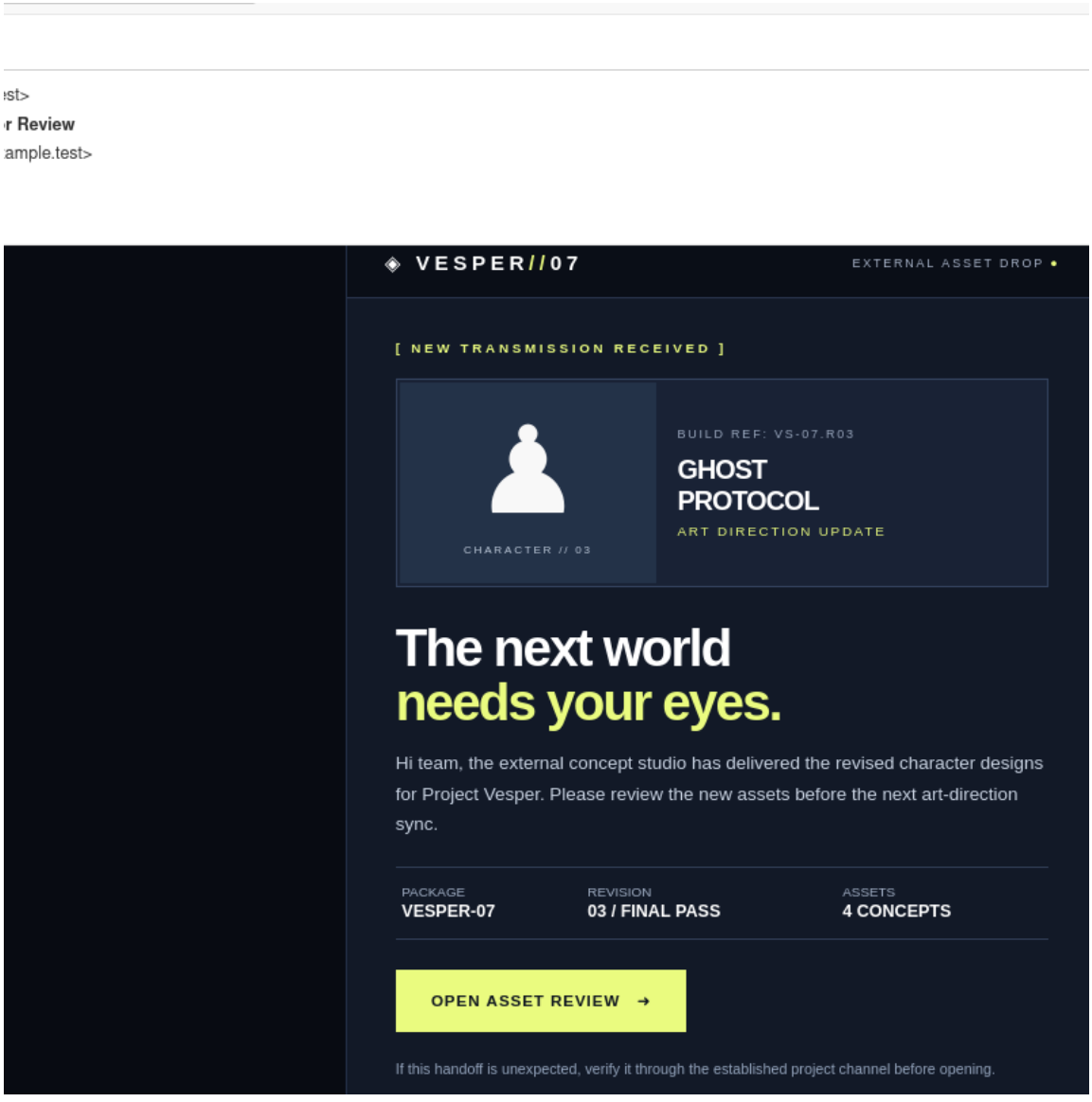


Figure 16. The final VESPER-07 email displayed in MailHog.

How the email click is recorded

When a recipient clicks OPEN ASSET REVIEW, Gophish receives a request containing that person's tracking ID (rid). It then records the Clicked Link event for that recipient. An email-open event can also appear if the tracking image loads. The REQUEST ASSET ACCESS button on the website only shows the awareness message.

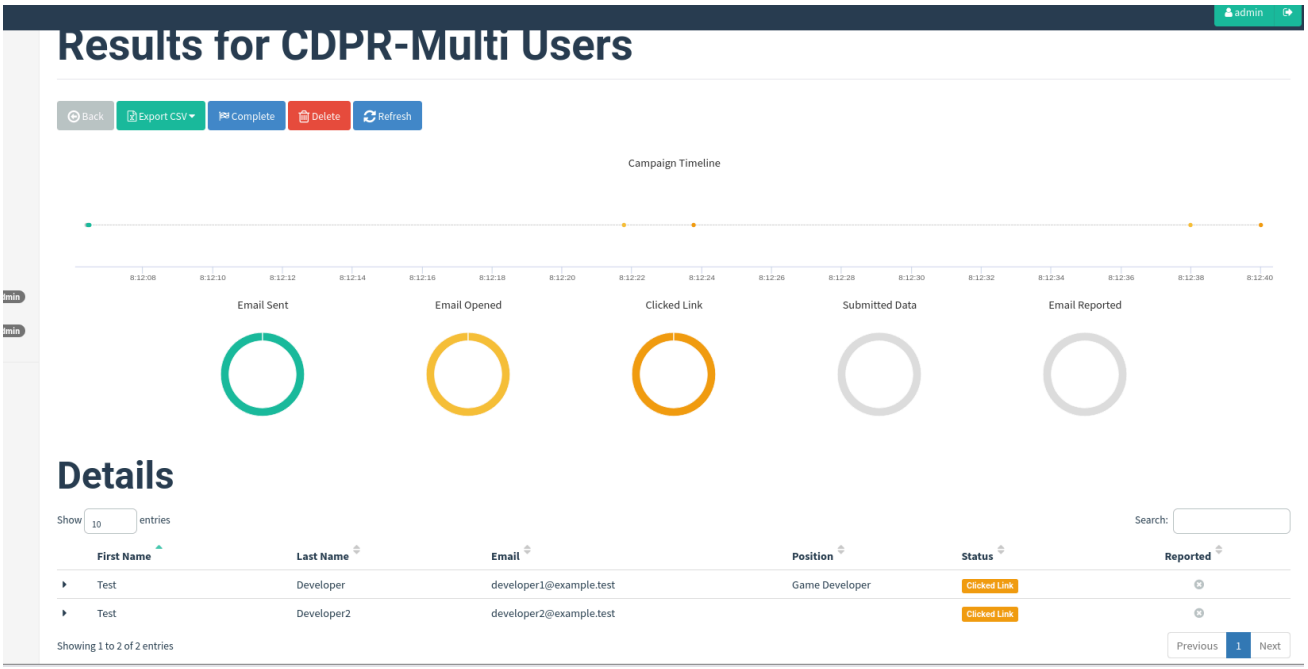


Figure 17. CDPR-Multi Users results: both test recipients clicked the tracked email link.

Figure 17 presents the final Gophish results for the CDPR-Multi Users campaign. Two test users received the phishing email, and both users clicked the tracked link. No data was submitted, because the landing page only displayed the awareness message and did not collect credentials.

Starting the tools for the demo

```
sudo systemctl start docker
sudo docker start cdpr-mailhog
sudo docker ps
cd ~/CDPR-gophish
./gophish
```

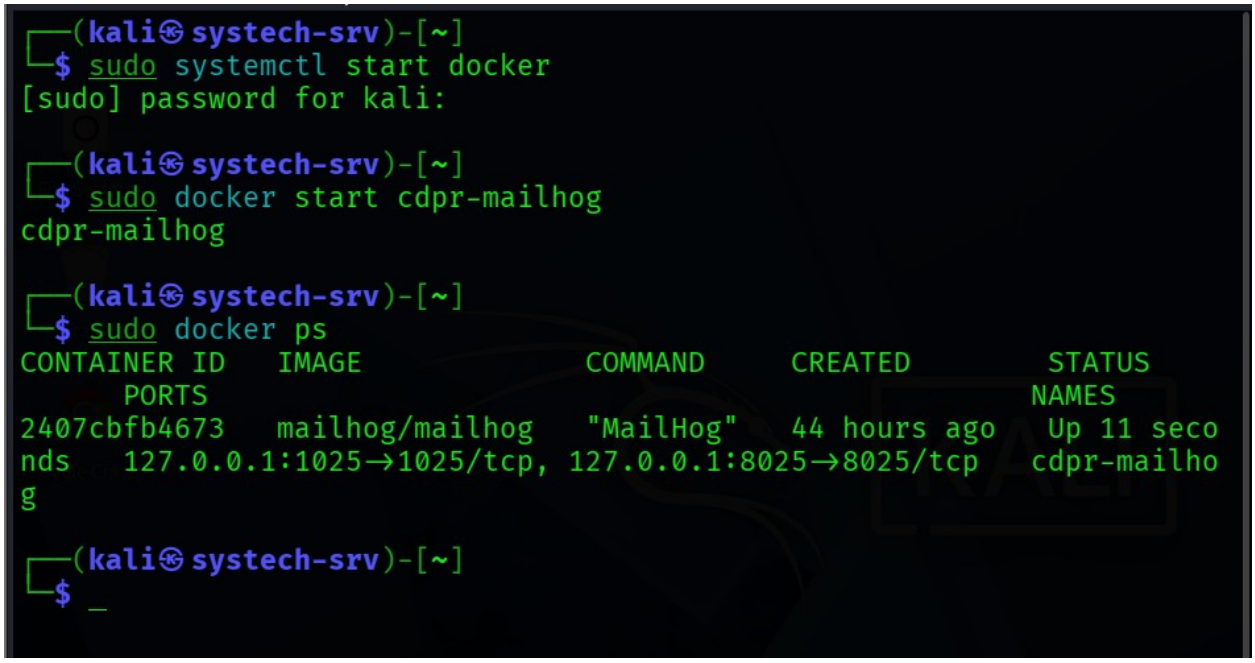


Figure 18. MailHog restarts before the presentation.

07 Security awareness for game developers

Game studios regularly share concept art and feedback with outside partners. That is why this email looks believable: it asks for a familiar type of review. But the message leads to a website that the developer has not checked.

After the demo, the workshop returns to the same email and website. Participants discuss a simple question: “Would I trust this message during a busy workday, and how could I check it?”

The best response is to confirm the request and website through a trusted project contact before signing in. If someone has already opened a suspicious link, they should tell the security team quickly so it can investigate.

The main lesson is simple: checking an unexpected email can help protect new game artwork, source code, and employee accounts.